

Read, send messages

Work with messages

With the  Messages app, you can send and receive text messages.

Read and reply to a message

When you receive a text message with the  Messages app, you'll see  in the [status bar](#).

1. Swipe the status bar down and tap .
2. To respond, type in the text box and tap .
3. Optionally:
 - To open an attached photo or file, tap it.
 - To [save an attachment](#), touch & hold it, then tap  > **Save**.
 - If the message is important, [star it so you can find it later](#).
 - If the message is from an unassigned number, [create a contact](#) to associate a name with that number.

Tips for incoming messages:

- You can [control message notifications](#), changing the sound or turning them on/off.
- If you don't want multi-recipient SMS messages converted to MMS and want replies sent in separate conversations (threads) to you only, [turn off group messaging](#).
- To protect your privacy, you can [hide sensitive content for lock screen notifications](#).

Send a message

1. [Open](#) the  **Messages** app.
2. Tap .
3. Enter recipients, then type the message.
4. Optionally:
 - To [add an attachment](#), tap  or .
 - To add a smiley or other icons, tap  on the [onscreen keyboard](#).
 - If you're using two SIMs and want to switch to the other to send the text, tap  and select the SIM.
5. Tap .

Tips for sending messages:

- To text your best friend with one tap from your home screen, [add a task shortcut](#). Touch & hold  and drag  to your home screen.